The height of the grasses depends upon the amount and distribution of rainfall.



Bison in Prairie



Prairie Dogs

The animals in this area include the bison, wolves of the Prairies of North America. The other animals and birds are coyotes, prairie dog, foxes, mice, rabbits, badgers, rattle snakes, pocket gophers, weasel, grasshoppers, quails and hawks.

vi. Tropical Desert Biome

A tropical desert is the hottest and driest place on earth where rainfall is very scanty and irregular. This biome is typically found in the western parts of the continents within the tropics.

In the northern hemisphere, the Afro – Asian deserts form the longest belt which includes the Sahara desert, Arabian desert and the Thar deserts. In North America the tropical deserts cover, California, Arizona

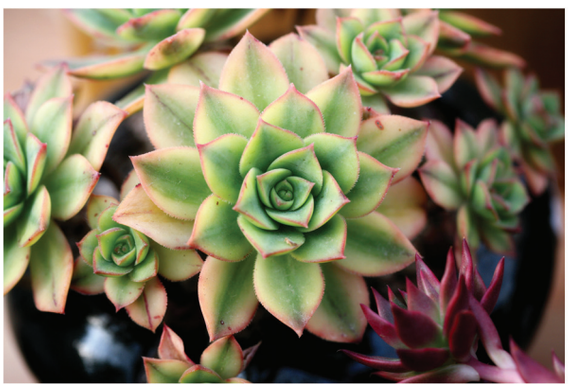


Thar Desert

and New Mexico states of USA and it further extends to Mexico. The deserts in the southern hemisphere are, the Atacama desert west of Andes mountains in South America, the Namibian and the Kalahari deserts in southern Africa and the Great Australian desert in the central and southern parts of Australia.

The tropical deserts are not conducive for the growth of vegetation due to shortage of water. The plants found here are the *xerophytes* which have their own moisture conserving methods such as long roots, thick barks, waxy leaves, thorns and small leaves so as to avoid evapo-transpiration.

The main trees and bushes found in this region are acacia, cacti, date palm, kikar, babul etc.



Succulent

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